

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

# split-compare

Two options + verdict — dark frame on the left, 2-column option grid + a recommendation card on the right.

The dark panel asks; the grid answers.

One question on the left; two option cards and a verdict on the right.

OPTION A

- Three short rows state the case
- Rows stay parallel across cards

OPTION B

- The grid begs comparison
- Mismatched rows read as bias

RECOMMENDATION

The verdict card lands last: one recommendation, one revisit date.

# Four rows per card is the grid's ceiling.

The panel question may run two lines when the cards run full.

Stress test · split-compare – Four rows per card – the ceiling.

## THE STRESSED FIRST OPTION

- Budget spent, one clause
- Rows compress the verdict
- The fourth is last
- Parallel, or it collapses

## THE STRESSED SECOND OPTION

- Symmetry is the grammar
- Four rows each, matched
- Eyes pair across cards
- Unpaired reads as missing

## RECOMMENDATION

Even at the ceiling the verdict stays one sentence — the loudest line on the slide.

# The dark panel asks; the grid answers.

One question on the left; two option cards and a verdict on the right.

OPTION A

- Three short rows state the case
- Rows stay parallel across cards

OPTION B

- The grid begs comparison
- Mismatched rows read as bias

RECOMMENDATION

The verdict card lands last: one recommendation, one revisit date.

The dark panel asks; the grid answers.

One question on the left; two option cards and a verdict on the right.

OPTION A

- Three short rows state the case
- Rows stay parallel across cards

OPTION B

- The grid begs comparison
- Mismatched rows read as bias

RECOMMENDATION

The verdict card lands last: one recommendation, one revisit date.

# The dark panel asks; the grid answers.

One question on the left; two option cards and a verdict on the right.

Composition: accent · split-compare  
accent

OPTION A

- Three short rows state the case
- Rows stay parallel across cards

OPTION B

- The grid begs comparison
- Mismatched rows read as bias

RECOMMENDATION

The verdict card lands last: one recommendation, one revisit date.

# When NOT to reach for split-compare.

## Three or more options

split-compare is strictly two — first card is the alternative, second card is the preferred. For three options, use `verdict-grid` or successive `decision` slides.

## No verdict

The blockquote is mandatory. Without it the slide collapses to a comparison without a call — use `compare-prose` for that case.

## Preferred on the left

Layout convention pins the preferred option to the second (right) card. Putting the recommendation first breaks the reading flow and the accent badge lands on the wrong card.

## RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`compare-prose` — the comparison is undecided — no verdict bar yet

`decision` — the verdict slide that follows a separate comparison

`split-panel` — the right side is findings, not paired options

`verdict-grid` — three or more options scored against shared criteria